02_relocation-bangkok-vs-dubai

RELOCATION ANALYSIS - BANGKOK vs DUBAI

Prepared: 11 September 2026 | **Board seat:** Strategic Wealth/Asset Advisor + COO **FX basis:** USD/NGN N1,334 official (10 Sep 2026) | USD/THB 32.9 | USD/AED 3.6725

1. ENTRY REQUIREMENTS & COST

	Thailand - DTV	UAE - Free Zone + Investor Visa
Financial proof	B500,000 (~$15,200), seasoned 3 months	None
Government fee	B10,000 (~$304)	Licence + visa package
All-in year 1	~$500-800	~$4,100-6,800 (AED 15,000-25,000)
Validity	5 years	2-3 years, renewable indefinitely
Stay per entry	180 days; one extension -> 360 continuous	Resident
Spouse/children	Dependants apply alongside primary	Sponsored as dependants
Work rights	Remote work for overseas clients only	Own your company; full residency

Investor visa by zone: RAKEZ AED 3,500-5,500 · IFZA AED 3,800-5,200 · Meydan AED 4,500-6,000.

2. TAX - THE DECISIVE VARIABLE

Thailand: 180+ days = tax resident. Foreign income taxed on REMITTANCE basis. Post-1 Jan 2024 income taxable if resident in the year derived AND remitted. Progressive PIT to 35%. As of 7 Sep 2026 the remittance basis still stands; worldwide-taxation proposals NOT enacted. KEY: only money brought into Thailand is taxed. Capital kept offshore is untouched.

UAE: 0% personal income tax. No remittance rules, no CGT on individuals. 9% corporate only above AED 375,000 (~$102,000) profit. No policy ambiguity.

Remitted/yr	Thai PIT	Effective
$25,200	$2,456	9.7%
$40,000	$5,897	14.7%
$60,000	$10,897	18.2%
$100,000	$22,857	22.9%

3. COST OF LIVING

Couple: Bangkok ~$2,100/mo = $25,200/yr · Dubai 3,650/mo = $43,800/yr * *Familyof3 : * *Bangkok* 4,280/mo = $51,360/yr · *Dubai* 6,000/mo = $72,000/yr

Dubai is 42.8% more expensive ex-rent, 82.5% including rent; rent 196.5% higher.

4. ALL-IN (couple, modest lifestyle, remitting only what is spent)

	Bangkok	Dubai
Living	$25,200	$43,800
Tax	$2,456	$0
TOTAL	$27,656	$43,800

Bangkok saves $16,144/yr. *Crossover* $87,000 remitted annually. The crossover is triggered by LIFESTYLE INFLATION, not income. Thailand taxes what you withdraw, not what you earn - a golden handcuff on your own wealth.

5. THE STRUCTURAL FLAW IN THE THAILAND PLAN

All four Thailand LTR categories are CLOSED to the subject:

- Wealthy Global Citizen: $1m assets + $80k income + $500k invested in Thailand
- Wealthy Pensioner: age 50+ (he is 30)
- Work-from-Thailand Professional: employer must have $50m revenue (he is self-employed)
- Highly-Skilled Professional: requires a Thai employer

DTV is a five-year renewable stay, not a residency ladder. Thailand is a staging post. The UAE free zone visa renews indefinitely and upgrades to Golden Visa at AED 2m - a ladder.

6. TIME ZONE (trading window captured Sep 2026)

Full window 8AM-7PM NY · PRIME window 10AM-1PM NY

	Full	Prime
Abuja UTC+1	1pm - midnight	3pm - 6pm
Dubai UTC+4	4pm - 3am	6pm - 9pm
Bangkok UTC+7	7pm - 6am	9pm - midnight

The nocturnal objection applies to the FULL window, not the prime one. cBot automation removes the constraint entirely.

7. BOARD RECOMMENDATION - SEQUENCE, DON'T CHOOSE

PHASE A - Bangkok on DTV. Lowest burn while trading income is proven. Remit only what is spent. Five years at ~27,656/*yrvs* 43,800 saves roughly $80,000 - itself relocation capital.

PHASE B - Dubai free zone at $150,000-200,000/yr trading income. Zero tax, time zone, broker infrastructure and the Golden Visa path all dominate from there.

Confirmed: move to Dubai BEFORE buying the St Kitts passport. Structure beats passport.

8. CANADA - PERMANENTLY CLOSED

Self-Employed Persons Program paused indefinitely. Start-Up Visa halted Dec 2025. Trading income cannot safely be made to count for CRS - a reference letter from a company you control is explicitly treated as MISREPRESENTATION (five-year ban), and no NOC describes trading one's own capital. Closed by joint decision of subject and Sarah, 18 Sep 2026. DO NOT RAISE AGAIN.

9. RESEARCH GAPS

- UAE free zone TOTAL cost of ownership (licence + visa + Emirates ID + medical + flexi-desk)
- Thai worldwide-taxation proposals - MONITOR QUARTERLY (scheduled task live)
- Bangkok international school fees, verified range
- UAE broker/prop-firm access and corporate account opening, Nigerian passport
- Nigerian tax residency exit rules on departure